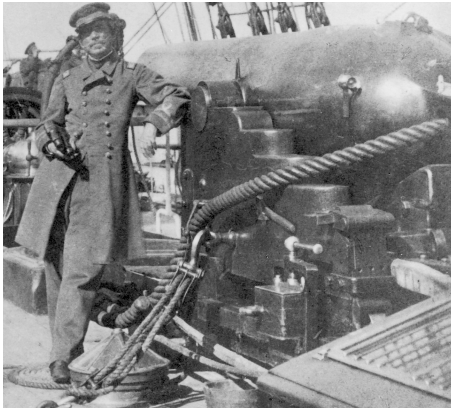


CONFEDERATE SEA CAPTAIN (1809-77)

RAPHAEL SEMMES



"Old Beeswax," as his sailors called Semmes after his waxed mustaches, was a native of the state of Maryland and a U.S. naval officer. At the outbreak of war, he followed his adopted state of Alabama into the Confederacy. He first won fame by taking 18 prizes as captain of CSS *Sumter*. After that ship was trapped in Gibraltar, the dashing Semmes escaped to England, where he took command of the fabled *Alabama*, the most successful commerce raider of the war. In 1865, back in Virginia, Semmes was given command of the James River

Squadron; but its sailors were soon turned into makeshift infantry, and when he surrendered them in April, he was holding the rank of brigadier general.